

Quick Start Guide

From download to your first budget in about ten minutes. Everything runs in your browser, offline, with no account.

1. Open the dashboard

1 Unzip the download

Right-click → Extract All (Windows) or double-click the ZIP (Mac).

2 Move the HTML file somewhere permanent

For example `Documents > Finance`. Your data is tied to where the file lives, so don't run it from Downloads or from inside the ZIP.

3 Double-click `Personal_Finance_Dashboard.html`

It opens in your default browser. Chrome or Edge give the best experience (they support automatic backup); Firefox and Safari work too.

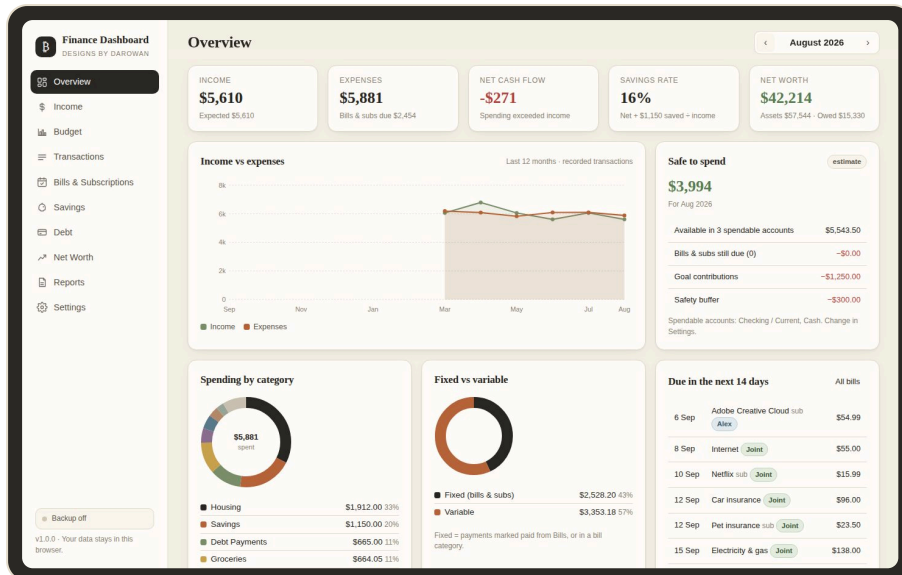
4 Bookmark it

Press Ctrl+D / Cmd+D so it's one click away next time.

2. Three-step setup

The first time you open it, a short wizard asks:

- **Who is it for?** Just you, or a couple. Couple mode tags everything to a person (or "joint") and adds per-person breakdowns. You can switch later in Settings.
- **Currency and start month.** The currency only changes the symbol and number format.
- **Sample data or empty?** Choose **Load the sample household** to explore with six months of realistic data. You can wipe it from Settings whenever you're ready.



The Overview after loading the sample household.

3. Enter your own data, in this order

- 1 **Income**
Add each salary or income source with its real pay frequency — weekly, fortnightly, monthly, or custom. Set the first pay date; the dashboard works out every future pay day from it.
- 2 **Bills & Subscriptions**
Add rent, utilities, insurance and every subscription. Give each a due day and frequency. The calendar, cash-flow forecast and safe-to-spend all build from these.
- 3 **Net Worth → accounts**
Add your current accounts, savings, investments and any credit cards or loans with today's balances. Tick the account types that count as "spendable" in Settings (checking and cash by default).
- 4 **Debt**
Add each debt with its balance, APR and minimum payment. Toggle Snowball / Avalanche and add an extra monthly amount to see your debt-free date.
- 5 **Savings → goals**
Target, saved so far, monthly contribution and an optional target date.
- 6 **Budget**
Type planned amounts straight into the table, or use **Suggest from last 3 months** once you have some transactions.

4. Day to day

Log spending

Transactions → **+ Add**. Split one receipt across categories with **+ Add split**. Or **Import CSV** from your bank — duplicates are flagged automatically.

Tick bills as paid

In Bills & Subscriptions, tick the **Paid** box for the month. That records the payment as a transaction, so the budget and safe-to-spend update instantly.

Change the month

Use < > in the top bar, or click the month name to jump. Every page follows it.

Print a report

Reports → **Print / Save PDF** for a monthly or annual summary.

5. Protect your data

Chrome or Edge: turn on automatic backup

Settings → Automatic backup → **Choose backup file...** Pick a location (a Dropbox, Drive or OneDrive folder works well). Every change is written there two seconds later and verified. Nothing is sent anywhere.

Any browser: one-click JSON backup

Settings → **Export backup (JSON)**. To move to another computer, open the dashboard there and use **Restore from backup...**

Don't move or rename the file, and don't clear site data

Both start a fresh, empty dashboard. Export a backup first, then restore it afterwards.

Need more detail? The User Guide explains every screen and every calculation.